"What other people think of me doesn't matter."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you tell yourself that other people's opinions of you simply do not matter? Do praise and criticism both seem to slide right off you? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward valuing the honest voices of people who care about you, and to find the wisdom that comes from knowing God's word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Some people learn early that other people's opinions were unreliable, harsh, or impossible to please, so they decide to stop caring. Others have been hurt so often by criticism that indifference feels safer than hope. There is a healthy freedom from the fear of what people think. The belief goes too far when it shuts out the caring feedback and encouragement that make us wiser.

How the belief can keep itself going

Not caring what anyone thinks feels strong and protects against hurt. But it also means the person stops hearing honest feedback, kind words, and gentle correction from those who truly care. Without those voices, nothing challenges the belief, and distance can grow without anyone noticing.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture frees us from the fear of man: "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high." But it does not tell us to stop listening to people altogether. "The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel." "The wounds of a friend are faithful." "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another." We do not live for people's approval, but we are wiser when we receive the counsel of those who love us.

> *"The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel." (Proverbs 12:15)*

Also see

> "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high." (Proverbs 29:25)
>
> "The wounds of a friend are faithful, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful." (Proverbs 27:6)
>
> "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another." (Proverbs 27:17)
>
> "He who listens to life-giving reproof will dwell among the wise." (Proverbs 15:31)

Common self-statements

- I do not care what anyone thinks.
- Praise and criticism mean nothing to me.
- Their opinions are irrelevant.
- I set my own standards.
- No one's view of me affects me.
- I do not need anyone's approval or advice.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing the choice as either caring about everyone's opinion or no one's.
- Mislabeling: Calling hurt "indifference."
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring kind words and helpful feedback.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning a few unreliable critics into "no one's opinion counts."
- Selective attention: Remembering the criticism and forgetting the encouragement.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unaffected and concluding that I really do not care.

Challenging questions

- Is it true that I do not care at all, or did I learn not to show it?
- Whose opinion did I once care about, and what happened?
- Is there anyone whose honest view I could trust?
- What might I be missing by not hearing what caring people think?
- What is the difference between living for approval and being open to counsel?
- What does Scripture say about listening to wise people?
- If a friend told me their opinion of me did not matter, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

I do not have to live for anyone's approval, and I do not have to be ruled by criticism. But the honest voices of people who care about me are a gift. I can stay free of the fear of man and still listen to wise counsel and kind words.

A short prayer

Lord, I stopped caring what people think because it hurt too much. Set me free from the fear of man, and help me receive the wisdom and kindness of people who love me. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Humility
- Wisdom
- Friendship
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Voice of Truth
Casting Crowns

Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Who Am I
Casting Crowns

Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say
Lauren Daigle

God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Jesus Loves Me
Gaither Vocal Band

This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where indifference to praise and criticism is one feature of a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships. A healthy independence from other people's opinions is not a problem; the concern is a rigid conviction that no one's view matters, especially when it narrows life or costs the person support. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Whose caring voice could I listen to today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "What other people think of me doesn't matter."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "What other people think of me doesn't matter." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "What other people think of me doesn't matter."

- ☐ Is it true that I do not care at all, or did I learn not to show it?
- ☐ Whose opinion did I once care about, and what happened?
- ☐ Is there anyone whose honest view I could trust?
- ☐ What might I be missing by not hearing what caring people think?
- ☐ What is the difference between living for approval and being open to counsel?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about listening to wise people?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I can be free of the fear of man and still listen to those who care.
- ☐ Wise people listen to counsel.
- ☐ A friend's honest word is a gift.
- ☐ I do not live for approval, but I can receive encouragement.
- ☐ Kind words can matter to me.
- ☐ I can choose whose voice to trust.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Proverbs 12:15
  "The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel."
- ☐ Proverbs 29:25
  "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high."
- ☐ Proverbs 27:6
  "The wounds of a friend are faithful, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful."
- ☐ Proverbs 27:17
  "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another."

☐ Proverbs 15:31
“He who listens to life-giving reproof will dwell among the wise.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Humility. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ List three times someone's kind or honest words helped you, and note how it felt.
- ☐ Ask one trusted person for their honest view on something small, and record what happened.
- ☐ Accept a compliment with a simple "thank you," and notice your reaction.
- ☐ Tell someone one thing you appreciate about them.
- ☐ Notice a time this week when you cared more than you expected.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to help you receive the good words of others.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about what God says about you and whose voice you want to hear.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~What other people think of me doesn't matter.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I am free from the fear of man, and I can still receive wise counsel and kind words from people who care.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Proverbs 12:15

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for freeing me from the fear of man. Help me to listen to the wise and kind voices You place around me. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #17 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · GIVEN UP ON PEOPLE

“I’ve given up on letting people in.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Have you stopped trying to let people get close? Does it feel as though your shield is up for good and you no longer expect anything to change? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward opening the door, even a crack, and to find the hope that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Long seasons of disappointment, rejection, or loss can lead a person to quit trying. The shield that was once raised for protection becomes permanent, and the person may even feel relief at no longer hoping. Emotions can seem “switched off” because feeling them hurt too much. This is a way of coping, and it is often a sign of past pain, not of coldness.

How the belief can keep itself going

Giving up does protect from fresh disappointment, so the belief feels sensible. But a closed door cannot be tested, and so nothing new ever happens to change it. Hope deferred is painful, and the person may not notice how much has been lost: comfort, laughter, help, and being known.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that “hope deferred makes the heart sick,” but it also says, “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds,” and “A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish.” God is gentle with those who have given up. “Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another.” Giving up on people is understandable. Giving up on God’s ability to heal and restore is not necessary.

> *“A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice.” (Isaiah 42:3)*

Also see

> “Hope deferred makes the heart sick, but desire fulfilled is a tree of life.” (Proverbs 13:12)

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.” (Psalm 147:3)

> “Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor.” (Ecclesiastes 4:9)

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest.” (Matthew 11:28)

Common self-statements

- I am done trying.
- It never works out.
- I have shut that part of me off.
- I would rather not hope.
- Nothing will change.
- I do not feel anything anymore.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing it is either perfect closeness or none at all.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that every attempt will end in disappointment.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling numb and concluding that I no longer need anyone.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting a few painful relationships stand for everyone.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking small moments of warmth.
- Mislabeling: Calling protection "giving up."

Challenging questions

- What happened that led me to stop trying?
- Was there a time I let someone in and it went well, even a little?
- What have I lost since I closed the door?
- Is it possible to open it only a crack and only for someone safe?
- What does it mean that God does not break a bruised reed?
- What would my life look like with one safe friend?
- If a friend told me they had given up on people, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

My shield was built for good reasons, and I do not have to take it down all at once. God is gentle with bruised hearts. I can open the door a little, for someone safe, and let Him heal and restore what I thought was gone.

A short prayer

Lord, I have put up my shield and I am tired of hoping. You do not break bruised reeds. Heal what has been wounded, and help me open the door a little, to someone safe. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Depression, Symptoms of

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Just Be Held
Casting Crowns

God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm
Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham

Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope
Phil Wickham

Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance
Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither

This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where a person has "given up" on others and emotions are switched off. A permanent shield is often protective and rooted in earlier injury. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Who could I open the door to, just a crack, today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I've given up on letting people in."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I've given up on letting people in." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "I've given up on letting people in."

- ☐ What happened that led me to stop trying?
- ☐ Was there a time I let someone in and it went well, even a little?
- ☐ What have I lost since I closed the door?
- ☐ Is it possible to open it only a crack and only for someone safe?
- ☐ What does it mean that God does not break a bruised reed?
- ☐ What would my life look like with one safe friend?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ God is gentle with bruised hearts.
- ☐ I can open the door a little at a time.
- ☐ Hope can be rebuilt slowly.
- ☐ One safe person is a beginning.
- ☐ Giving up was protection, and I can choose differently.
- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Isaiah 42:3
  "A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice."
- ☐ Proverbs 13:12
  "Hope deferred makes the heart sick, but desire fulfilled is a tree of life."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor."

☐ Matthew 11:28
“Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Hopeless. Listen to Overcoming Depression. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ List three times someone showed you kindness, and note how it felt.
- ☐ Say hello to one person you would usually avoid, and stay for a minute.
- ☐ Send a short message to someone you have not spoken to in a while.
- ☐ Accept a small invitation, and stay a short, set time.
- ☐ Spend a few minutes noticing something good about one person.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to bring one safe person into your life.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being held, healed, and given hope.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I've given up on letting people in.~~

NEW TRUTH:
God is gentle with my bruised heart. I can open the door a little, to someone safe, and let Him restore what I thought was lost.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Isaiah 42:3

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for being gentle with me. Give me courage to open the door a little, and bring safe people into my life. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #18 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · CLOSENESS ISN'T IMPORTANT

"Close relationships aren't important to me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you feel that close relationships just are not important to you? Do you see little reason to be intimate with anyone? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward seeing how God made us for connection, and to find the joy that comes from knowing His word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

When earlier closeness brought pain, demands, or disappointment, a person may decide that intimacy is not worth the cost. Others genuinely feel little pull toward people, and over time they conclude that relationships do not matter. Family and friends may notice that the person has become emotionally distant, even in marriage, and that they seem unmoved by what once mattered.

How the belief can keep itself going

Not needing closeness feels tidy and low-maintenance. But the people around us, including spouses and children, may feel the distance, and the person misses what only relationships can give. Because the belief spares the person from the risk of closeness, it rarely gets tested.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is clear that relationship is part of how God made us. "It is not good for the man to be alone." "Love the Lord your God with all your heart... The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.'" Jesus said, "By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another." "A friend loves at all times." We were made to give and receive love. Even when closeness is hard, it matters to God, and learning to be close can be a gift for us and those who love us.

> *"The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'" (Genesis 2:18)*

Also see

> "By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another." (John 13:35)

> "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity." (Proverbs 17:17)

> "The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I do not need you.' Nor can the head say to the feet, 'I do not need you.'" (1 Corinthians 12:21)

> "We love because He first loved us." (1 John 4:19)

Common self-statements

- Intimacy is not important to me.
- I do not need anyone close.
- Relationships are not worth the effort.
- I am fine without a close connection.
- I am simply not a relational person.
- Others make too much of closeness.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning “I find closeness hard” into “closeness is unimportant.”
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing relationships as either intense or unnecessary.
- Mislabeling: Calling a fear of being hurt “not needing anyone.”
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring warm moments with others.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling little and concluding that nothing matters.
- Selective attention: Counting the costs of closeness and overlooking the gifts.

Challenging questions

- Have close relationships always felt unimportant, or did something change?
- What did closeness cost me in the past?
- What do the people who love me say they miss?
- What might I be missing by not letting anyone close?
- What does Scripture say about how God made us?
- Is there a kind of closeness that feels manageable, such as shared activities or conversation?
- If a friend told me close relationships do not matter to them, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

Close relationships matter to God, and they matter to the people who love me. If closeness has been painful or unnatural, I can move toward it slowly, in ways that fit me. I was made to love and be loved.

A short prayer

Lord, You made me for relationship, even when it feels unnatural. Soften my heart, show me the value of closeness, and help me love and be loved at a pace I can manage. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Loneliness
- Love for Others
- Marriage

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

If We Are the Body
Casting Crowns

The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

The God Who Stays
Matthew West

God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

I Am Not Alone
Kari Jobe

God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus
Keith and Kristyn Getty

This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where intimate relations are held to be unimportant. In clinical experience, a spouse may be the one who first notices the detachment. A preference for limited social contact is not itself a problem; the concern is a rigid conviction that closeness has no value, especially when it costs the person support or strains a marriage. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What small act of connection could I offer today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Close relationships aren't important to me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Close relationships aren't important to me." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "Close relationships aren't important to me."

- ☐ Have close relationships always felt unimportant, or did something change?
- ☐ What did closeness cost me in the past?
- ☐ What do the people who love me say they miss?
- ☐ What might I be missing by not letting anyone close?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about how God made us?
- ☐ Is there a kind of closeness that feels manageable, such as shared activities or conversation?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I was made for relationship.
- ☐ Love matters to God, and it matters to those who love me.
- ☐ Closeness can start small.
- ☐ I can move toward people at my own pace.
- ☐ I can give love, even if I do not feel it strongly.
- ☐ Connection can add to my life.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Genesis 2:18
  "The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'"
- ☐ John 13:35
  "By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another."
- ☐ Proverbs 17:17
  "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:21
  "The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I do not need you.' Nor can the head say to the feet, 'I do not need you.'"

☐ 1 John 4:19
“We love because He first loved us.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Friendship. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Ask someone you love what they enjoy doing together, and do it for a short time.
- ☐ Tell one person something you appreciate about them.
- ☐ Share a meal with someone and focus on listening.
- ☐ Ask your spouse or a close family member how you could be more present, and listen without defending.
- ☐ Spend a few minutes noticing what you enjoy about being with a particular person.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to teach you the value of love.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being made for connection and love.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Close relationships aren't important to me.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I was made for relationship. Closeness matters to God and to those who love me, and I can grow in it at my own pace.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Genesis 2:18

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for making me for relationship. Teach me to love and receive love at a pace I can manage. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #19 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · KEEPING THINGS PRIVATE

"I shouldn't confide in anyone."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you keep your thoughts and feelings to yourself because you do not want to confide in anyone? Does it feel safer to carry everything on your own? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward sharing with someone safe, and to find the relief that comes from knowing God's word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

A confidence that was betrayed, a childhood where private things were mocked or used against us, or a home where feelings were not welcome can teach us that keeping things to ourselves is the only safe way. Privacy is a healthy value. The belief goes too far when it becomes a rule that no one can be trusted with anything.

How the belief can keep itself going

Not confiding does keep us from being exposed, so the belief seems to work. But the person misses the comfort, perspective, and prayer that come from sharing, and carries everything alone. Because nothing is shared, the belief never meets a trustworthy listener.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors wise privacy: "A gossip reveals a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence." So safe people exist, and we can seek them. "The intentions of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out." "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed." And God Himself invites us: "Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge." We can begin with God, then share a little at a time with someone who has earned trust.

> *"Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge." (Psalm 62:8)*

Also see

> "A gossip reveals a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence." (Proverbs 11:13)

> "The intentions of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out." (Proverbs 20:5)

> "Oil and incense bring joy to the heart, and the sweetness of a friend is counsel to the soul." (Proverbs 27:9)

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ." (Galatians 6:2)

Common self-statements

- It is safer to keep things to myself.
- Nobody can be trusted with my secrets.
- Sharing only makes things worse.
- I should handle my own business.
- What I say will be used against me.
- Privacy is the only protection.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must tell everyone everything or tell no one anything.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that anything I share will be betrayed.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting one betrayal stand for everyone.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how a listener would react.
- Selective attention: Remembering broken confidences and forgetting kept ones.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling exposed and concluding that sharing is dangerous.

Challenging questions

- What happened that taught me not to confide?
- Has anyone ever kept something I shared? What happened?
- What is the difference between healthy privacy and carrying everything alone?
- What signs show that a person can be trusted?
- What could I tell God, who already knows everything?
- What small thing could I share first, and with whom?
- If a friend told me they could not confide in anyone, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

Privacy is wise, and so is finding a safe person to confide in. I can start with God, who hears everything, and share a little at a time with someone who has earned trust. I do not have to carry it all alone.

A short prayer

Lord, You know my heart. Teach me to pour it out to You, and to find one trustworthy person to share with. Keep me from carrying everything alone. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Confession
- Friendship
- Trust
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

He Knows
Jeremy Camp

Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Just Be Held
Casting Crowns

God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

I Am Not Alone
Kari Jobe

God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus
Keith and Kristyn Getty

This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where confiding in others is avoided. Many clients have a history of breached confidences, so trust must be earned in session; clear explanations of confidentiality and its limits help. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What could I tell God, and who might be safe to tell next?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I shouldn't confide in anyone."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I shouldn't confide in anyone." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "I shouldn't confide in anyone."

- ☐ What happened that taught me not to confide?
- ☐ Has anyone ever kept something I shared? What happened?
- ☐ What is the difference between healthy privacy and carrying everything alone?
- ☐ What signs show that a person can be trusted?
- ☐ What could I tell God, who already knows everything?
- ☐ What small thing could I share first, and with whom?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I can pour out my heart to God.
- ☐ Trustworthy people keep confidences.
- ☐ I can share a little at a time.
- ☐ Privacy and sharing can both be wise.
- ☐ I do not have to carry everything alone.
- ☐ A friend's counsel is sweet to the soul.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Psalm 62:8
  "Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge."
- ☐ Proverbs 11:13
  "A gossip reveals a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence."
- ☐ Proverbs 20:5
  "The intentions of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out."
- ☐ Proverbs 27:9
  "Oil and incense bring joy to the heart, and the sweetness of a friend is counsel to the soul."

☐ Galatians 6:2
“Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Confession. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Write a letter to God telling Him everything on your heart.
- ☐ List the safest people you know and what makes them safe.
- ☐ Share one small, low-risk thing with a safe person, and note how they responded.
- ☐ Ask a trusted person what helps them feel safe confiding in others.
- ☐ Notice a time someone kept your confidence.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to bring one trustworthy listener into your life.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being known by God and held in His care.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I shouldn't confide in anyone.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I can pour out my heart to God and, in time, share a little with someone safe. I do not have to carry it all alone.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Psalm 62:8

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for hearing everything. Give me a trustworthy listener, and help me share a little at a time. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #20 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · NOTHING IS ENJOYABLE

“Nothing is much fun anyway, so I might as well be on my own.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you find that little brings you pleasure, so you wonder why you should bother with other people? Have activities that once felt enjoyable lost their spark? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward rediscovering joy, and to find the gladness that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Sometimes the capacity for enjoyment fades. This can follow long stress, loss, depression, or years of keeping people at a distance, and sometimes a person has simply always been somewhat quiet and low-key. When fun fades, the reasons for joining others fade with it, and being alone becomes the default.

How the belief can keep itself going

If nothing feels enjoyable, staying home seems reasonable. But less activity and less company usually mean even fewer enjoyable experiences, which confirms the belief. Enjoyment often returns slowly, after we do things, not before.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture treats joy as one of God’s gifts. “You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence.” God “richly provides all things for us to enjoy.” “There is nothing better for them than to rejoice and do good while they live… this is the gift of God.” “A joyful heart is good medicine, but a broken spirit dries up the bones.” If joy has faded, it may be a signal to care for the body and heart, seek help, and slowly try small things with safe people.

> *“You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand.” (Psalm 16:11)*

Also see

> “Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy.” (1 Timothy 6:17)

> “A joyful heart is good medicine, but a broken spirit dries up the bones.” (Proverbs 17:22)

> “You turned my mourning into dancing; You peeled off my sackcloth and clothed me with joy, that my heart may sing Your praises and not be silent.” (Psalm 30:11–12)

> “Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor.” (Ecclesiastes 4:9)

Common self-statements

- Nothing is fun anymore.
- I do not enjoy anything.
- Why bother going out?
- I am happier on my own.
- Social events are a waste of time.
- I do not feel much of anything.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Feeling flat and concluding that nothing could be enjoyable.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing something is either thrilling or pointless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that an activity will not be enjoyable.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking small pleasures when they happen.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning “this was dull” into “nothing is fun.”
- Selective attention: Counting the letdowns and overlooking the pleasant moments.

Challenging questions

- What did I enjoy in the past, and when did it fade?
- Has anything brought even a little pleasure recently?
- What happens to my mood when I stay home all the time?
- Could stress, tiredness, or low mood be dimming my enjoyment?
- What small activity could I try, even if I do not expect to enjoy it?
- What does Scripture say about joy as a gift?
- If a friend told me nothing was fun anymore, what would I suggest?

Truth summary

Joy is a gift from God, and it can return, often slowly. When enjoyment fades, I can care for my health, try small things, and spend time with safe people, even before I feel like it. Being alone is not the only option, and I do not have to settle for a flat life.

A short prayer

Lord, You are the giver of joy. Restore my capacity to enjoy what You have given, and lead me gently toward people and activities that bring me gladness. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Joy
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Loneliness
- Thankful

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Thinking, Healthy
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Already There
Casting Crowns

God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive
Casting Crowns

Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Living Hope
Phil Wickham

Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness
CeCe Winans

This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where infrequent participation in activities for fun or pleasure is one feature. Reduced pleasure (anhedonia) is also a core feature of depression, so screen for depression and, when indicated, suicide risk; refer for evaluation if enjoyment has recently declined, if sleep or appetite have changed, or if there are thoughts of self-harm (in the U.S., call or text 988). This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What small, pleasant thing could I try today, even if I do not expect to enjoy it?"

My Plan for Replacing "Nothing is much fun anyway, so I might as well be on my own."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Nothing is much fun anyway, so I might as well be on my own." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "Nothing is much fun anyway."

- ☐ What did I enjoy in the past, and when did it fade?
- ☐ Has anything brought even a little pleasure recently?
- ☐ What happens to my mood when I stay home all the time?
- ☐ Could stress, tiredness, or low mood be dimming my enjoyment?
- ☐ What small activity could I try, even if I do not expect to enjoy it?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about joy as a gift?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Joy is a gift from God.
- ☐ Enjoyment can return.
- ☐ Small steps can bring gladness.
- ☐ Being active often brings back pleasure.
- ☐ I do not have to settle for a flat life.
- ☐ Company can add to my joy.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Psalm 16:11
  "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand."
- ☐ 1 Timothy 6:17
  "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy."
- ☐ Proverbs 17:22
  "A joyful heart is good medicine, but a broken spirit dries up the bones."

- [ ] Psalm 30:11–12
  "You turned my mourning into dancing; You peeled off my sackcloth and clothed me with joy, that my heart may sing Your praises and not be silent."
- [ ] Ecclesiastes 4:9
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Joy. Listen to Overcoming Depression. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Make a list of things you enjoyed in the past, and try one for ten minutes.
- ☐ Rate your mood before and after a short walk or outing.
- ☐ Do one small thing you used to enjoy, whether or not you feel like it, and note what happens.
- ☐ Invite a safe person to join you in a simple activity.
- ☐ Notice and write down one pleasant moment each day.
- ☐ Write a prayer thanking God for one good thing and asking for more joy.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about joy and God's goodness.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Nothing is much fun anyway, so I might as well be on my own.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Joy is a gift, and it can return. I can take small steps toward people and activities, even before I feel like it.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Psalm 16:11

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for the gift of joy. Restore it in me, and lead me gently toward people and things that bring me gladness. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.